sanas South African National Accreditation System

NON-CONFORMANCE, CORRECTIVE ACTION AND CLEARANCE REPORT

SANAS No.: T1195

Organisation Name: **Azuresky Laboratory** | NC Report Number: **AB15**

Area/Scope Assessed: **Management Requirements** | Assessor / Inspector / Expert: **A. Bougart**

PART 1: DETAILED OBSERVATION

At the time of the assessment, it was observed that the lab manager conducted an internal audit on 29/01 to 20/02/2026 whereby there was not clear evidence of the impartiality of the audit as his role as the lab manager of the lab he was auditing and he was also the analyst that was audited using a vertical assessment.

Signed (Representative):

Signed (Team Leader / Inspector): A. Bougart

MAJOR: [X] MINOR: [ ]

Reference No. of relevant Guide / Standard / Requirement: **ISO/IEC 17025 requirement 4.1.1**

Date: **08/04/2026**

PART 2: ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

(Provide an analysis of the extent and cause of the nonconformity)

Oversight the lab did not clearly assess the risk associated with electing the lab manager to be the lead auditor for the sub-clause to be audited.

PART 3: CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

(Clearly indicate what corrective action was taken, and attach supportig evidence of implementation)

A risk assessment to impartiality associated with internal audit has been conducted, with existing controls to be implemented when planning internal audit.

An internal audit has been conducted, implementing one of the controls to use the managing director/ops manager as they are not involved in the system to safeguard impartiality.

Impartiality policy revised to include conflict of interest disclosure by the internal auditor

Date: 17/05/2026

Signed (Representative): Mpanga

PART 4: CORRECTIVE ACTION VERIFIED AND CLEARED

(Comment on whether the corrective action is sufficient and appropriate)

Date:

Signed: Assessor / Inspector/Expert:

PART 5: FOLLOW-UP AT NEXT ASSESSMENT

(Comment on the implementation of the corrective actions)

Date:

Signed: Assessor / Inspector/Expert:

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AS004MF 07/25

BRAINSTORMING FORM

IRQ no: AB 15

Brainstorming team

Tshepo Maponya
Keitumetse Maleka
Sizwe Nyambi

What went wrong? It was observed that the lab manager conducted the internal audit to 29/01 to 20/02/2026 whereby there was no clear evidence of impartiality of the audity as his role as the lab manager of the lab he was auditing her was also the analyst that was audited using vertical assessment.

~~What went wrong?~~ Why was there no clear evidence of impartiality?
As part of his role in the lab, the lab manager was responsible for developing, implementing and maintaining the system so the audit served to be like him auditing his own work.

Why was impartiality not safe guarded by the laboratory?
Oversight, the lab did not clearly assess the risk associated with electing the lab manager to be the lead auditor

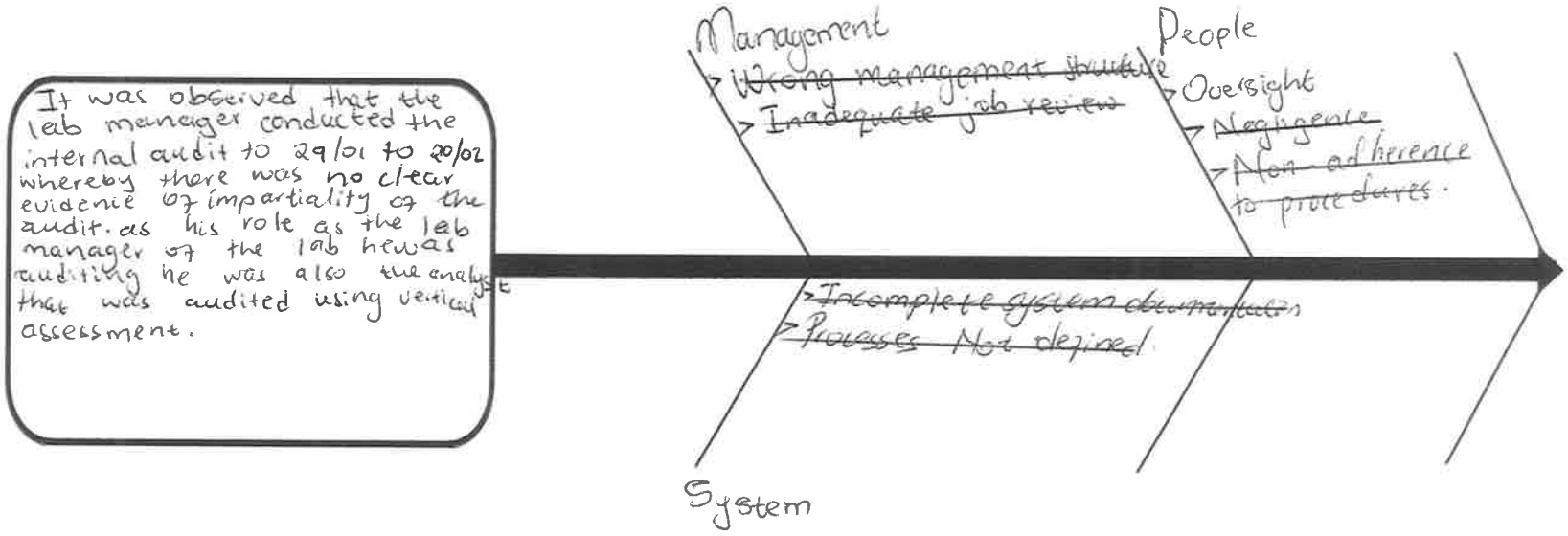
Supervisor: Maponya

AS001MF

07/25

ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS FORM

IRQ NO: ABIS



SUPERVISOR

Risk Assessment

2. Causes (of the risk)	
1	Self-Audit: The personnel directly involved in an area or part of an area of the management system with which they are responsible for, appointed to audit the same area.
2	Technical Conflict: Laboratory analyst leading technical audits in their own area of routine operation
3	Hierarchical Pressure: Junior staff auditing senior management, leading to a reluctance to report major findings (Intimidation threat).
4	Resource Constraints: Lack of trained personnel leading to the same individual auditing all laboratory sections.
5	
6	
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1. Risk
Internal Audit

3. Consequences (of the risk)		
1	Undetected Non-conformance: Serious technical or quality system failures remain hidden, compromising data integrity	
2	Loss of Accreditation: Failure to meet ISO/IEC 17025 Clause 8.8 requirements regarding auditor independence	
3	Misleading Management Review: Management receives a "false positive" report suggesting the lab is compliant when it is not.	
4	Reduced Customer Confidence: If errors are later found by clients, the lab's reputation for rigorous internal oversight is damaged	
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		

	4. Existing Controls for the Causes (affecting the likelihood of the risk)	Eff	Control Owner
	Cross-Departmental Auditing: Ensuring auditors do not audit their own work or immediate workspace.	Ti	Operations Manager
	External Peer Review: Using qualified personnel from a nother laboratory or an external consultant to conduct the audit.	Ti	Managing Director
	Impartiality policy revised to include the requirement auditors to sign a conflict-of-interest disclosure before each audit.	Ti	Lab Manager/Supervisor
	Audit Team Rotation: Rotating audit assignments annually to prevent familiarity threats	Ti	Lab Manager/Supervisor
	Management Oversight: Utilizing the Managing Director or Operations Manager to audit the system, as they are not involved in its initial building or implementation.	P	Lab Manager/Supervisor

	5.Likelihood	Matrix	Control Owner
	- 99% probability, or - impact is occurring now, or - could occur within "days to week"	E5	Operations Manager
	- > 50% probability, or - balance of probability will occur, or - could occur within "weeks to months"	D4	Operations Manager
	- 99% probability, or - impact is occurring now, or - could occur within "days to week"	E6	Operations Manager
	- > 50% probability, or - balance of probability will occur, or - could occur within "weeks to months"	D3	Operations Manager

BEFORE

	IMPARTIALITY POLICY		
AzurESky	Document no: ASMF4.2		
	Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**	
	Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

Commitment to remaining autonomous

To ensure independence and objectivity and protect impartiality risks within us as an organization and from any outside influence, the following needs to be enforced:

- Continuous mandatory disclosure of conflicts of interests
- Separate commercial functions from technical decision-making, ensuring that financial pressures do not affect scientific integrity.
- Disclosure of incentives from clients and registering them in the incentive register form (This is to protect personnel from any undue pressure in the organisations' activities.)

Responsibilities

Managing directors and Operations managers' responsibility is to safeguard impartiality and provide sufficient resources to maintain independence.

Laboratory Managers/Supervisors' responsibility is to monitor and oversee impartiality risk and come up with plans to mitigate any that may arise.

All personnel are to adhere to this policy and report any potential impartiality concerns.

Reviews and communication

The policy is to be reviewed annually via a committee with the following present, top management representative as defined in the organogram

The policy must be communicated as part of induction procedures to new employees and annual communication made to personnel.

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
07/2025	00	07/2028

CONTROLLED DOC

AFTER

	IMPARTIALITY POLICY		
AzurESky	Document no: ASMF4.2		
	Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
	Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

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- Disclosure of incentives from clients and registering them in the incentive register form (This is to protect personnel from any undue pressure in the organisations' activities.)
- Internal Auditors are mandated to sign impartiality disclosure to make sure that anyone in the organisation does not audit their own work, thereby deeming them fit to audit the clauses in question

Responsibilities

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Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
05/2026	01	05/2029

CONTROLLED DOC

AFTER

AzurESky	**IMPARTIALITY POLICY**	
	Document no: **ASMF4.2**	
	Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**
	Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**

Revisions

Revision no	Content changed	Reason for revision
01	Added impartiality disclosure by internal auditors in the section, "commitment to remaining autonomous"	Consistency in applying clause 4 of ISO 17025 across the system.

CONTROLLED DOC

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
05/2026	01	05/2029

	Azuresky	
AzurESky	CONFLICT OF INTEREST DISCLOSURE	Document no: ASMF 4.2 Disclosure
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

1. Objective and Scope

In accordance with the Impartiality Policy, all appointed internal auditors must complete and sign this disclosure before participating in any internal audit activity. The purpose of this declaration is to safeguard the objectivity of the audit process and guarantee that auditors do not audit their own work, their direct areas of responsibility, or any activities where a personal or professional conflict of interest exists.

2. Auditor and Audit Details

- **Auditor Name:** N. P. Msibi
- **Audit Number / Reference:** ISO 17025 clause 6 & 7
- **Scheduled Audit Date(s):** 13 May – 14 May 2026
- **Laboratory Areas / Quality System Clauses to be Audited:** Management System

3. Impartiality Declaration

By signing below, I, the appointed internal auditor, declare and confirm that:

- **No Direct Involvement:** I am not directly or indirectly involved in the daily operations, technical procedures, or management of the specific laboratory areas or quality system processes scheduled for this audit.
- **No Self-Auditing:** I am not auditing my own work, records that I have generated, or training that I have personally conducted or received within the current audit cycle.
- **Independence of Reporting:** I am free from any commercial, financial, or organizational pressures that could bias or influence my audit findings and conclusions.
- **Disclosure of Changes:** If, during the course of the audit, I discover a potential conflict of interest or a threat to my impartiality, I will immediately halt the session and notify the Management.

	Azuresky	
AzurESky	CONFLICT OF INTEREST DISCLOSURE	Document no: ASMF 4.2 Disclosure
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

4. Conflict of Interest Check

Please check the appropriate box below:

☒ **No Conflict:** I have reviewed the scope of this audit and confirm there are no known conflicts of interest or threats to impartiality.

☐ **Potential Conflict Identified:** I have identified a potential conflict or area of involvement (please detail below for management review).

Description of potential conflict (if applicable):

_____

_____

5. Signatures and Authorizations

Internal Auditor Signature: Signature: _____
Date: 13 May 2026

Reviewed and Approved by (Management Representative): *The signed declaration has been reviewed, and the auditor's impartiality is deemed sufficient to proceed.*
Signature: _____ Date: 13/05/2026

Note to File: This completed and signed form must be retained alongside the final internal audit report as objective evidence of compliance for external accreditation assessments.

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
08/05/2026	00	05/2029

	ATTENDANCE REGISTER		
AzurESky	Document no:	Version:	Page:
	ASMF 17043-8.4.1	0	1
	Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
	Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	
Date:	16/05/2026		
Chair:	TMS Mapanya	Scribe	
Subject:	Revision 07 Impartiality Policy 4.2		
Absent:			

Present	Cell Number	Designation	Signature	Email address
TMS Mapanya	0764550692	Lab Supervisor	TMSMapanya	tshepo@azuresky.it.com
N. Msibi	0827868149	QA Manager		nonhlanhla@azuresky.it.com
SB Nyambi	0721741857	Lab Manager		sifiso@azuresky.it.za
K Mtelca	071 724 9031	Lab Analyst	K. Mtelca	kate.mtelca@azuresky.it.com

AzurESky

ATTENDANCE REGISTER

Document no:	Version:	Page:
ASMF 17043-8.4.1	0	1
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

Date:	13.05.26		
Chair:	N. Msibi	Scribe	
Subject:	Internal Audit - Clause 6. (MS-F8) + 7		
Absent:			

Present	Cell Number	Designation	Signature (Opening)	Email address	Signature (Closing)
N. Msibi	0827868149	Operations Manager		msibinc@west.co.za	
SB Nyambi	0721741852	Lab Man		nonhlanhla@azuresky.it.com	
				Sifiso@azuresky.it.com	
TM Mapanga	0765550692	Lab Supervisor		tshepo@azuresky.it.com	

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South African National Accreditation System

MANAGEMENT REQUIREMENTS OF ISO/IEC 17025:2017

Organisation's SANAS No/s.

Date/s of evaluation	13 May 2026
Assessor/s & Observers	N. Msibi
Laboratory	**Azuresky (Pty) LTD**
Area / field of operation	ISO 17025 Clause 6 ; 7 of F48
Laboratory Representative	Tshepo Mapoma

This report covers the following:

Document Review only		Implementation on Site Visit only		Document Review and Site Visit		Other	

Compliance = C, Non-compliance = NC

REQUIREMENTS & COMMENTS. ***Compliance = C, Non-compliance = NC***

NB1: *References to ISO/IEC 17025:2017 are in italics & indicated as Std. The order of assessment need not follow the order of the checklist. Assessors are expected to know & have the standard, this worksheet is designed as guidance to prompt detailed recording of the process.*

REFER TO ISO/IEC 17025:2017 FOR DETAIL AND FOR CLARIFICATION NOTES.

NOTE 1: *For **CAB's comments**: The CAB must provide information on how requirements have been addressed, documented and/or implemented. Make reference to policies / procedures, incl. clause numbers.*

NOTE 2: *For **Assessor's Comments**: The Assessor must provide information on the CAB's conformity with the requirements*

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CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 REQUIREMENTS How are the following addressed / implemented	CAB's COMMENTS	Cl NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
6.6.1	Suitable externally provided products and services that affect the laboratory are used.	The lab sends the required needs to service provider Also there's checklist to evaluate clients.		
6.6.2	Procedure and records for:			
	Defining, reviewing and approving lab requirements for products and services	Selection, Evaluation & monitoring of contractors As per 6.2 to Is available & implemented		
	Defining criteria for evaluation, selection, monitoring of performance and re-evaluation.	There's checklist, listing the criteria for the evaluation. (measureable)		
	Externally provided products and services conform to lab's established requirements.	Yes		
	Taking action from evaluations, monitoring of performance and re-evaluations.	Need to perform evaluation of supplier from the last years service/ Experience		

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CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 REQUIREMENTS *How are the following addressed / implemented*	CAB's COMMENTS	CI NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
6.6.3	Communication by the laboratory its requirements to external providers:			
	Products and services to be provided;	Email to be Microsoft produced to		
	Acceptance criteria;	show that CAB does communicate acceptance.		
	Competence including required qualification;	The checklist has this requirement for evaluation		
	Activities (either lab or customer) intents to perform at the external providers premises.	11		
7	PROCESS REQUIREMENTS *How are the following addressed/implemented?*			
7.1	Review of request, tenders and contracts			
7.1.1	Procedure for the review of request, tenders and contracts.			
a)	Requirements adequately defined, documented and understood.	ASMF 4.7.1. Procedure to handle contractual matters. ASMF 4.1.2.	Checklist.	

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CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 REQUIREMENTS *How are the following addressed / implemented*	CAB's COMMENTS	CI NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
	b) Capability and resources to meet the requirements.	Incorporate testing requirement. = Review document. 4.1.2 - done		
	c) Advice customer and gain approval for activities performed by external provider			
	d) Selected methods are capable of meeting customer requirements.	Checklist 4.1.2. covers this point.		
7.1.2	Customer informed as to the method chosen.	N/A		
7.1.3	When the statement of conformity is requested, clearly define the decision rule.	The CAB reports results & Client decides on a way forward.		
7.1.4	Differences resolved before work commences.	~~N/A~~		ASME 4.7.1 Clause 3.4

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CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 REQUIREMENTS *How are the following addressed / implemented*	CAB's COMMENTS	Cl NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
7.1.5	Customer informed of any deviations from the contract.	ASMF 4.7.1 clause 3.6		
7.1.6	Amendment after work commenced, review repeated, communicated to affected personnel.	3.7 of 4.7.1 added wording "communicate to the affected personnel"		
7.1.7	Cooperation with customer in clarifying customer requests and monitoring the labs performance.	Yes. 3.4. of 4.7.1		require clarification in writting with Customer
7.1.8	Records maintained: reviews; significant changes; pertinent discussions with customer.	Clause 4 of ASMF 4.7.1 does cover this.		
7.9	Complaints			
7.9.1	Documented process: receive, evaluate and make decisions.	ASMF ~~7.16~~ 7.18 B N.P Covered.		
7.9.2	Description of the handing process – available to any interested party on request.	Covered		

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CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 REQUIREMENTS *How are the following addressed / implemented*	CAB's COMMENTS	Cl NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
	Confirm whether the complaint relates to lab activities.	Covered. Clause 5.		"lab Manager shall determine if complaint is valid"
7.9.3	Process for handling complaints: process for receiving, validating, investigation and decision on action; tracking and recording; appropriate action taken.	All Covered.		
7.9.4	Responsibility of the laboratory for gathering and verifying all information.	lab Manager/Supervisor.		
7.9.5	Whenever possible, acknowledge receipt of the complaint, provide progress reports and the outcome.	Yes it's there.		
7.9.6	Outcome reviewed by individuals not involved in original laboratory activities.	Clause 6.		
7.9.7	Whenever possible, give formal notice at the end of complaint.	Communication done in writing Clause 6.	shall be	

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CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 REQUIREMENTS How are the following addressed / implemented	CAB's COMMENTS	Cl/ NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
7.10	Nonconforming work			
7.10.1	Procedure for activities that do not conform to procedures or requirements.	ASMF 7.17		
a)	Responsibility and authorities.	Defined in clause 3		
b)	Action based upon risk levels established by the laboratory.	Clause 4		
c)	Evaluation of the significance of the NC.	Clause 4		
d)	Decision taken on acceptability of the non-conforming work.	Clause 4		

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CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 REQUIREMENTS *How are the following addressed / implemented*	CAB's COMMENTS	Cl NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
e)	Customer is notified and work re-called, where necessary.	Clause 7.		
f)	Defined responsibility for authorizing the resumption of work.	To be added on procedure	NC	→ reviewed to be a gap. not NC.
7.10.2	Records of nonconforming work and actions.	✓		
7.10.3	Corrective action promptly followed, where evaluation indicates possible recurrence or doubt about compliance of the laboratory's operations with its own policies/procedures.	Clause 8.		
7.11	**Control of data and information management**			
7.11.1	Access to the data and information needed.	Yes CAB has		
7.11.2	LIMS: Validated for functionality. Changes such as laboratory software configuration or modification to commercial off-the shelf software – Authorised, documented and validated before implementation.	There is proof.		

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CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 REQUIREMENTS How are the following addressed / implemented	CAB's COMMENTS	CI NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
7.11.3	Laboratory information management system (LIMS)			
a)	Protection from unauthorised access	Personnel are allocated passwords		Analyst have access to technical forms / procedures ei ✓
b)	Safeguarding from tempering and loss	LIMS Ensure that for analyst only PDFS are available to them. There's external hard drive to store information every day.		
c)	Operated in environment that complies with specifications.	must located on/to a fixed area in the lab.		
d)	Maintained to ensure the integrity of the data and information	tracks all events prohibits any changes without Supervisors approval.		
e)	Record system failures and appropriate immediate and corrective actions.	Logs every events No failures have occurred.		
7.11.4	LIMS managed and maintained off-site or through an external provider, the provider /operator must comply with the std.	Yes.		

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Additional / General Comments *This space may also be used to expand on comments in specific sections*
No NC recorded

Representative: Mpanya

Team Leader's Signature:		**Date:**	13 May 2026

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